BRIGHAM YOUNG
UNIVERSITY
IDAHO

ED 211: Teaching as a Profession

- **Class times: T/Th 10:15-11:15 HIN 307.**
- **Office hours: M/T/Th 12:30-3 HIN 249.***
- **Lab hours: F 4-6 PM. HIN 307.**

Part I: Course Introduction

Instructor: Benjamin Pacini **(**But, like, call me BroPa). pacinib@byui.edu**. 801.618.7865.**** Zoom: 899.634.5818.

Formal Description:
Me: *Steps up to lectern. Clears throat.*
Me: *Talks in fancy, academic tone*
"This course is a survey of projects using major EdTech tools that are commonly used in the classroom. The course focuses on utilizing these tools to support and apply research-based principles for learning in a diverse and rapidly changing field of education. The course content is based on Idaho core curriculum skills for students in the K-8 setting, and provides students with technology proficiencies for integrating technology into teaching."
Real-life Description:
Me: *bursts out laughing*
Me: "Did I scare you? I hope I scared you. Look, I hope someone important reads that and thinks that I'm a serious professor, because I'm totally faking it. Y'all we're about to have so much fun. We do crazy projects, redesign education, watch hilarious cat videos, and do penguin hunts. Tons of work, but tons of fun. Also memes. And sucrose. (Candy.) AND PENGUINS HOW COULD I FORGET PENGUINS!"

Course Introduction and Invitation:

Are you afraid of technology? Are you not sure what the internet is? Not yet sure what it means to rick-roll someone*****? Well have I GOT THE CLASS FOR YOU!

This class is about helping you figure out technology to use in your classroom, but also to ask questions that you've never asked before: what is school really for? How can we make education better? How can I be a life-changing teacher? You'll also learn what technology has to do with helping your students succeed (hint: everything). All this, and a dash of restored gospel: because we aren't just here to be good teachers, we're here to be "a place of educational innovation perpetually." We'll talk about what BYU-Idaho offers that is unique, and how it can help you, your future students, and the world. And it can–not only help, but change the world.

The goal is *not* simply to have you master EdTech--it's to learn how to master tech tools in general, because the things we learn will be obsolete soon. Your job is to *learn how to learn.* Also, I don't apologize for being an overly-excited, happily intense, moderately insane personal trainer. Feel the burn--and love it! We work hard, but it'll change the way you see everything in life.

Welcome to Ed 211. Buckle up. We're going to have fun. So excited to have you!

Brother Benjamin Pacini (BroPa)

*Seriously, just come by. I'm off campus Wed/Fri, but other times I'm easy to find. I'll bring the memes, candy, and dad jokes. You bring… you. I guess. Or don't.
**I'm a terrible texter. I'm mediocre at answering phones, but I'm decent w/email. Best of all is the zoom channel, which I'll show in class.
***This is your first penguin. PENGUIN! (Still only counts as one.)
**** Google voice is great because it has a great spam screen to keep out detestable vacuum salespeople. Say who you are, and it'll put you through.
***** See here. The RickRoll is the highest form of humor. Fight me.

Part II: Mission, Outcomes, Standards, and Alignment

The BYU-Idaho Teacher Education Department Vision:

Follow the example of the Savior to become outstanding educators who empower learners to reach their divine potential

BYU Idaho Mission Statement and Institutional Learning Objectives:

BYU-Idaho's mission is to develop disciples of Jesus Christ who are leaders in their homes, the Church, and their communities.

BYU Idaho Institutional Learning Objectives:

1. **Disciples of Jesus Christ:** Disciples of Jesus Christ have a testimony of Jesus Christ as the Son of God and strive to follow Him.
    1) Understand Doctrine and Principles of the Restored Gospel
    2) Make and Keep Covenants
    3) Live Standards of Honor and Integrity
    4) Work as Faithful Stewards of The Lord

2. **Sound thinkers:** Sound thinkers frame and solve problems using creative and critical thinking.
    1) Problem Solving
    2) Critical Thinking
    3) Inquiry and Analysis
    4) Innovation/Creativity

3. **Effective Communicators:** Effective communicators develop and express ideas that are purposeful, organized, and clear.
    1) Structure Content to Accomplish Specific Purposes
    2) Follow Appropriate Processes of Content Development
    3) Address Targeted Audiences Using Appropriate Modes of Delivery
    4) Express Ideas Clearly

4. **Skilled Collaborators:** Skilled collaborators work effectively with others to accomplish a shared vision.
    1) Fulfill Individual Responsibilities
    2) Facilitate Contributions of Others
    3) Foster Productive Group Climates
    4) Respond to Conflicts in Constructive Ways

How does this relate to our class?
I think you will find that every one of these ILOs is reflected in the design of this class. We will be working together in groups (ILO 4.2) to assess the quality of various EdTech tools (ILO 2.2). We will make a podcast (ILO 3.3) to explain what the quality of various EdTech tools are (ILO 2.2) , and edit it and add music, fade-ins, etc. (ILO 3.1) We will discuss the role of discipleship in teaching, and how teaching is a holy art. (ILO 1.4) We will talk about the potential of students, and your own potential as children of God. (ILO 1.1) We will do all of this in the context of living up to the honor code, (ILO 1.3) of making the world better through innovation and education, (ILO 1.4 and ILO 2.4) and through finding ways to help and serve even in times of strain. I suspect there are more ties--but I hope you can feel the light and inspiration coming from these. They have been crafted through inspiration, and striving to live up to them will be a blessing to you.

Course Outcomes:
Teacher candidates will:

1. Model community-building through technology, with a focus on collaboration and digital citizenship;
2. Learn principles of lesson design and technology integration, including technology evaluation, assessments, and intentional learning experiences.
3. Accelerate student achievement, creativity, and learning through technological tools;
4. Prepare leaders in EdTech implementation who are capable of evaluation, implementation, and ongoing reflection;

The course content is based on Idaho core curriculum skills for students in the K-8 setting.

KUDOS (Know, Understand, Do)
Students will know:

- How to evaluate various Educational Technology tools on criteria such as cost, accessibility, data, and community-generated resources.
- What a penguin looks like.
- How to rate EdTech tools on the most widely-used EdTech frameworks.

Student will understand:

- That teachers have tremendous power in advocating for making wise purchasing decisions regarding EdTech.
- That the education job landscape is changing, and future teachers can adapt through entrepreneurial thinking and deliberate preparation.

Students will have the capacity to do the following:

- Use each of the major EdTech tools that are the focus of projects in the class to push student achievement.
- Begin considering tools, plans, and strategies to build digital citizenship, community, and social-emotional learning.
- Begin building an online portfolio of excellent projects to use in job-seeking.
- Contribute to the conversation on the changing nature of the education landscape.
- Effectively navigate a changing, dynamic job market.
- Contribute to the future path of education as an industry.

Common Assessments:

1) E-Portfolio (through Portfolium) 2) Digital Citizenship & Responsibility Brochure (Canva project)

Course Assessments:
The primary assignments in this course are projects and readings. The major 13 projects are as follows:

- Personal Introduction Video (PIV)
- Gamification Project
- Google Teacher Certification Level I Exam
- Social Media Project
- Interactive Project I: (FlipGrid)
- Interactive Project II: (Playposit)
- Interactive Project III: (GoReact)
- Interactive Project IV: (NearPod)
- SEL: Class Dojo
- Communication and Multimedia I (e.g. Canva, etc.)
- Communication and Multimedia II (LMS/Website)
- Podcast/YouTube
- Innovation Project

ISTE Standards:
The technology skills you will learn are based on the standards developed International Society for Technology in Education (ISTE). The standards and the evidence from class assignments are listed in the following table:

International Society For Technology in Education (ISTE) Standards	Evidence
1. Facilitate and inspire student learning and creativity Teachers use their knowledge of subject matter, teaching and learning, and technology to facilitate experiences that advance student learning, creativity, and innovation.	Innovation Project Screencast Lesson
2. Design and develop digital age learning experiences and assessments Teachers design, develop, and evaluate authentic learning experiences and assessments incorporating contemporary tools and resources to maximize content learning in context and to develop the knowledge, skills, and attitudes identified in the Standards.	Nearpod Lesson GoReact Assignment Penguins are not evidence
3. Model digital age work and learning Teachers exhibit knowledge, skills, and work processes representative of an innovative professional in a global and digital society.	Portfolio Penguin Canva Posters
4. Promote and model digital citizenship and responsibility Teachers understand local and global societal issues and responsibilities in an evolving digital culture and exhibit legal and ethical behavior in their professional practices.	Digital Citizenship Assignment ePortfolio
5. Engage in professional growth and leadership Teachers continuously improve their professional practice, model lifelong learning, and exhibit leadership in their school and professional community by promoting and demonstrating the effective use of digital tools and resources.	ePortfolio Reading and attendance checks

Part III: Course Breakdown and Grading:

Course Breakdown:

- **Groups**: We will sort you into groups in the first week or two of class. Your group membership is one of the most important predictors of your success in this class. You should get each other's numbers, text early and often, connect, and consider each other running buddies. (A running buddy is both a friend and an accountability

partner.) If your group is running at peak-efficiency, you will make good friends and have a deeply joyful experience. Please let me know ASAP if your group is struggling with communication or work completion.
    - **Teaches:** Within your group, each person will be assigned to teach various times during the semester. They will be responsible for explaining the assignment using the best possible quality teaching techniques and methods. In particular, they are expected to use some or all of the following, or to otherwise assess student learning:
        - Plickers
        - Socrative
        - Jamboard
        - If you use a Kahoot so help me I will haunt you. Don't you even think about it, penguin.
        - Google slides will be tolerated. Barely.
- **Major projects**: The major work of the class is contained within projects. These projects are meant to teach you how to be an expert in the use of specific educational technologies. These projects can always be submitted early, and can be resubmitted as many times as needed to earn a high grade--if the project is submitted before the deadline. These projects will all be put into one place (Portfolium) so that future employers can see your excellent work, and that of your projects.

- **Readings**: I assign an eclectic blend of readings from practical to silly to inspiring and joyful. My goal is to teach you to learn to read in different ways (e.g. carefully or quickly) depending on need, and also to start a habit of regular, careful consumption of education research, news, and current events. You should spend a total of roughly 90 minutes per reading, including note-taking. Stop at 90 minutes and reach out to me. Students will participate in reading activities, including oral exams, fishbowls, etc. The purpose is both accountability and to foster rich discussion. Penguin. Please note that not being prepared for class is a minor grading issue. Pretending to be prepared when one is not is an integrity issue. Students will have the chance to opt out of one reading per semester with no consequence, called "a mulligan" so long as they communicate this before the class begins.

- **Contribution to Community**: One of the most important parts of this class (to me) is modeling for you how important a strong community is. This includes attendance, but also positive contribution to class, such as submitting memes to the thread, capturing great quotes, or providing a bit of daily inspiration. You will be asked to do fun, silly, joyful things just for the sake of making connections.

- **Technology proficiency exam**: It is required for graduation that you succeed in passing the Google Teacher Certification (Level I) assessment, and so I have made it worth a grade in this class to attempt such an exam, independent of whether you pass or not. It is 5% of your grade, and so should encourage you to get it done. You should be able to get it done fully independently, but I will offer reminders during class.

Participation and Attendance
Attendance is necessary--but not sufficient for--success in this class.

In addition, I want you to build the habits of character to be intentionally positive, solutions-oriented, creative, genuine, proactive, friendly, etc--precisely because there is so much negativity in the world. It matters more than you know. Do not plaster on a fake smile--be authentic. Ask questions, participate, and build others up. Be present in class (that means two different things: do both).

You should come looking fancy on days when you are teaching. Remember "dress down" days? Make it a "dress up" day.

I will attempt to record all class sessions, but you should not rely on those as recordings sometimes fail. You should get the information you need from class. In the event of technical failure, students are still responsible for the learning that takes place in sessions. Attendance matters in both synchronous and asynchronous instruction.

Questions and Communication
In the first week of class, you will learn about our zoom channel: please check it daily. (You can check on any non-chromebook computer, or any smartphone.) While I'm always happy to answer questions, please do all you can to ask peers and consult class materials (e.g. syllabus) before reaching out. Questions that may apply to the whole class can be asked in the Zoom chat; personal questions should be emailed. I encourage people to ask their group first, the zoom channel second, the TA third, and BroPa fourth--to build your capacity to answer your own questions. That said, just ask! I love interacting with students, and will happily answer even if you go out of order.

Grading:
Please reference the University's grading explanation here. Letter Grades are assigned according to the following scale:

A	93-100	A-	90-93	B+	87-89	B	83-86
B-	80-82	C+	77-79	C	73-76	C-	70-73
D+	67-69	D	63-66	D-	60-62	F	0-59

Grade Breakdown:

5%	Technology Competency Exam
15%	Readings & Oral Exams (Reading Reflections)
15%	Contribution to Community (Participation and Attendance Checks)
20%	Weekly Teaches
40%	Major Projects (Portfolium)

Grading Procedure and Philosophy:

Here is the general grading scale that I use for most rubrics, which is based off the DCPS Essential Practices rubric (the formal evaluation rubric used for scoring teachers professionally in Washington D.C.)

Highly Effective (4/3)	Effective (3/3)	Developing (2/3)	Ineffective (1/3)
Quality is that of an experienced, highly effective teacher. Student achievement will be strongly positive as a result of this learning experience.	Quality is that of a highly-motivated college student who has done high-quality work. Student achievement will be positive as a result of this learning experience.	Quality is that of average college student quality. Student achievement will be flat because of this learning experience.	Does not meet the criteria for a score of 2. Penguin.

Notice that in the rubric above, a 3/3 is full credit, but you can stretch to get a 4/3. I will grade you as I evaluated real teachers: getting a four would mean that you are doing impressive work *for a veteran, highly effective professional educator.* This lets me hold you accountable in a fair way that maintains a high bar of rigor while still letting you grow.

Peer Grading: You will do a lot of peer grading and peer feedback. You are about to be teachers, so this is good training. I expect you to grade with **kindness, honesty, and care**. While you will give suggested grades, I am ultimately responsible for grades in this course.

Grade Appeals: If you would like to appeal a grade, please email me. Note that I will regrade any assignment once--but I regrade the full assignment, not just the piece that a student may feel was unfair.

Extra Credit: Make-up work opportunities and extra credit are approved at my discretion; focus on submitting high quality projects first. Impressive projects, high quality work, or powerful insights can also earn some extra credit points. Sometimes good memes. Rarely. But sometimes.

Part IV: Course Expectations and Explanations:

Required Course Materials:

- You will need a functioning laptop. It is your job to make sure it works. (Not joking.)
- You will need a quality pair of headphones. (Quality doesn't mean expensive.)
- Bring a nameplate (Or make one using white card stock and black marker. Write large and clear.)
- You will need a dry erase marker, a sheet protector, and something to use to erase with (old sock is fine).
- You will need access to your BYUI email and the course zoom channel.

Paying for EdTech:
The only thing you will have to pay for in this class is the Google Teacher Certification Exam Level 1. It costs $10. Otherwise, you will never be required to pay for apps, but if you have already purchased them you are welcome to use them. As a teacher, it's important to find a way to spend as little as possible to get the job done. Reach out if you can't access a technology. The only payment will potentially be for a tech exam, which will be explained in class. (Do not sign up for something costly. If you do, you will be required to pay the full cost.)

Course Policies and Procedures:

Statement on dress code, masks, and honor code:
I'm only a little evil, but I am evil. I am a former middle school teacher, and assistant principal. Be wise. Be kind to yourself, and keep the rules without being asked. Be kind to me by not making me say something awkward. Wear masks. Put them over your nose. Keep the honor code. If you have an issue with anything, bring it up *before* you break it. Also, I see those holes in your jeans, and I'm judging you. (Not actually, lol. Mostly.) Also, I am pretty evil. Lol. Seriously.

Dress Code:

- For regular classes attendance: BYUI-approved dress and grooming standards. Masks required. No holes.
    - I love all of you dearly. Please don't make me have to talk with you about silly things.
    - Holes in jeans are a silly thing. (It's about professionalism.)
    - Do head-shoulders-knees-and-toes with a roommate if you're not sure. We will discuss in class.
- For Presentations: Show effort in your appearance to present and demonstrate professionalism. Masks required.

Late Work
You can always submit work early--and are encouraged to. Major projects that are submitted on time or early may be ***submitted and resubmitted as many times as necessary to get to the grade you desire.***[1] You will also get feedback on each submission to help you improve the quality of your work: the goal is to learn from the process of submission, feedback, improvement, and resubmission. Late submissions on ***major projects only*** will not be penalized except that you only get one shot to submit. Late reading checks and attendance checks will be penalized, but only a little–and you can still turn them in for partial credit no matter how late they are. You will get somewhat less feedback if you submit late, and you will be graded by me. I will not intentionally grade you harshly, but I do tend to grade more harshly than peers and TAs.

Some assignments cannot be submitted late by their nature (like group presentations). Submitting them late without prior approval will result in an automatic zero grade. Minor assignments are generally not accepted late.

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[1] Mastery Based Learning (most effectively promulgated by the brilliant--and brilliantly named--Benjamin Bloom) is a different education paradigm where we flip time and mastery. Rather than hold time constant, and let mastery fluctuate, MBL says that you can take all the time you need on a project, but you must get an excellent score on it. This means that students can work ahead, and go slower if needed. It's really good stuff, and I highly recommend you check it out. See here for more details. (The video is meh, but the documents are pretty good.)

Please be mature and professional about extenuating circumstances. (*cough* family-vacations-aren't-emergencies *cough*) You will find me to be very understanding, if you are very responsible. It's your job to reach out to me early!

Zeroes

Because of my unusual grading system, you will get more zeroes than you are used to. Don't stress. Talk to me. If you have a zero, the chances are good that you missed something important and I need you to try again. Also, note that I ask the TAs to always put in zeroes once an assignment is done. I find that it is kinder to students in the long run when they know

Submitting Links:
Check your links. If they are not working, you will receive **a permanent penalty**, but will be allowed to resubmit. Until we get a working link, you will have a zero.

Note on Emotional Health
I believe strongly that creating emotionally strong, resilient students is about both decreasing stress, and increasing capacity. If discussions of emotional health are sensitive or difficult for you, please let me know as early as possible. I do not claim to have all the right ideas on this, but feel it to be important enough to bring up and discuss.

Additionally, I suspect that many of you lean toward perfectionism: teaching will help with that. You will learn, quickly, the art of "good enough." You should never feel the need to spend 3 hours on a 1 hour assignment. Be wise. Learn how to manage your own time carefully. Learn that excellence is better than perfectionism (including in grades) and know the difference between integrity and scrupulosity.

A thought on emotional health and grades: I hope all of you are aiming for an A. But I hope you realize that the real goal isn't the A, it's the learning--it's the success that you'll have in your classroom someday because of what you learned, the students' lives who will be changed, and the relationships you'll build with teachers, parents, students, and communities--and most importantly, the Lord. This is a very long-term game. You will see your success measured not in months, or even years, but decades and generations.

Sensitive Topics
The world is in tremendous turmoil. The devil is stirring men's hearts up unto anger, and it's hard to even have conversations on some topics. Elder Paul V. Johnson has asked faculty to have both "moral courage" and "intellectual courage." I do not believe that it is in your best interest for me to avoid difficult conversations. To the contrary, learning how to wrestle with difficult topics is one of the most important things you can take from your BYU-Idaho education. As such, I will attempt to do so with openness, sensitivity, and honesty. If there are questions that are important to you, don't hesitate to ask me privately--and if appropriate, I may raise such issues in class, as well. I should also be clear that everything these days is politicized, and everyone is angry. The solution is not to disagree less, but to disagree better. I do not expect you to agree with everything I say--I only expect respect and civility. In that context, I'm happy to discuss things that are pressing to you.

I also want to note just how deeply I believe in the gospel. I want anyone to feel welcome in my classroom, even if they aren't sure about some part or another. Having said that, I hope it is clear how unapologetically I am on the side of the Lord and His church.

On social media and my writings:
A student once complained that I require students to follow me on social media. (I don't. Lol.) You are welcome to, but you are never going to be required to. You should understand that I have opinions on things, including politics, and that we may not agree. If you are willing to be my friend, I'll be happy to add you–but I will not give any brownie points or extra credit for it.

I also have a podcast and write occasionally in various places. If you would like to listen to my podcast, please click here. (Also, and I say this with love, get a hobby.)

Two of the pieces I have published may be relevant to my classes, however, so I have included them below.

You Are Safe In My Classroom: A Personal Statement on Truth, Belonging, and Pride Flags. This article is an explanation of how important it is to create a safe place of belonging in my classroom, and also why I don't use pride imagery. It isn't perfect, but it may give you insight into how I feel about things.

An Open Letter to Charity: What I Believe About Education In response to a student's question, I wrote this doctoral paper to answer the question "what do I believe about education?" This is long. I need to edit it (and hope to at some point). It does, however, give the best answer I've been able to come up with about what I believe we should do about education. (I've even left in my professor's comments so you realize how long it is! :D)

Course Calendar
The Course Calendar outlines all assignments, topics, and modules of the class. The instructor reserves the right to make changes in the schedule and syllabus. Students will be informed of changes in a timely manner. This calendar may be found in canvas (iLearn) under the syllabus tab.

Syllabus Changes
This syllabus is a guide and every attempt is made to provide an accurate overview of the course. However, circumstances and events may make it necessary for the instructor to modify the syllabus during the semester and may depend, in part, on the progress, needs, and experiences of the students. Changes to the syllabus will be made with advance notice.

Part V: Standard Disclosures

Academic Honesty
"When you are honest in every way, you are able to enjoy peace of mind and maintain self-respect. You build strength of character, which allows you to be of service to God and others. You are trustworthy in the eyes of God and those around you. If you are dishonest in your words or actions, you hurt yourself and often hurt others as well. If you lie, steal, cheat, or neglect to give the full amount of work for your pay, you lose your self-respect. You lose the guidance of the Holy Ghost" ("Honesty," True to the Faith (2004), 84)

Academic Honesty means students do their own work. This also means their instructors will evaluate that work. Students should not be dishonest—this includes all types of work in their courses. The complete Academic Honesty Policy can be found at http://www.byui.edu/student-honor-office/ces-honor-code/academic-honesty.

All students attending BYU-Idaho have agreed in writing to adhere to the Honor Code. Cheating, which includes plagiarism, will not be tolerated. This includes using materials you did not create and claiming them as your own. Using ideas and resources shared in the teaching community is supported, however you must give attribution and add your own ideas, experience, etc. to found resources. Please check with the instructor before using resources such as Teachers Pay Teachers and Influencer produced materials. Anyone caught cheating will receive a zero on the assignment or exam, will be reported to the Student Honor Office, and may be expelled from the course.

Academic Support
Go to http://www.byui.edu/AcademicSupport , or come to the McKay Library 272 for information about how the writing, reading, math, and study skills centers can help you increase your success in all of your classes. To schedule a tutor for a specific class, log on to the Academic Support website, click on Tutor Request under Student Services and follow the instructions. Penguin. I'm evil, lol. Who puts a penguin in the standard disclosures? That's like supervillain level evil.

Academic Grievances

Students are encouraged to contact their instructors regarding course-related concerns. If concerns cannot be resolved in this way, students may contact the BYU-Idaho Support Center to formally register a concern or grievance. The Student Grievance Policy can be found here.

Disability Services
BYU-Idaho does not discriminate against persons with disabilities in providing its educational and administrative services and programs and follows applicable federal and state law. This policy extends to the University's electronic and information technologies (EIT).

Students with qualifying disabilities should contact the Disability Services Office at disabilityservices@byui.edu or 208.496.9210. Additional information about Disability Services resources can be found at http://www.byui.edu/disabilities

I am very easy to work with on this. Please know, however, that the best thing I can do for any student is give them resources, empower them, and hold them to a high bar. Talk with me early if I can help in any way. PENGUIN.

Preventing Sexual Misconduct
BYU-Idaho prohibits sex discrimination by its employees and students in all of its education programs or activities. This includes all forms of sexual harassment, such as sexual assault, dating violence, domestic violence, stalking, conditioning a grade or job on participation in sexual conduct, and other forms of unwelcome sexual conduct.

As an instructor, one of my responsibilities is to help create a safe learning environment for my students and for the campus as a whole. University policy requires deans and department chairs, and encourages all faculty, to report every incident of sexual harassment that comes to their attention. If you encounter or experience sexual harassment, please contact the Title IX Coordinator at titleix@byui.edu or 208-496-9209. Additional information about sex discrimination, sexual harassment, and available resources can be found at www.byui.edu/titleix.